Riansares 4R — safety, permits, services and hazardous materials

What should be done if water reaches sockets or the electrical panel?

Avoid touching wet electrical equipment and surfaces. Do not operate switches in a flooded or hazardous area. Seek a safe way to isolate the supply **only if this can be done without exposure**, and request help from a competent professional or emergency services if there is serious risk. Do not recommend improvised electrical repairs.

Can I move sockets when renovating a kitchen?

This can be included in the project, but circuits, protective devices, loads, water locations and technical requirements must be checked. In Spain, the Low Voltage Electrotechnical Regulation provides the regulatory framework. Execution and certification must comply with applicable obligations and involve authorised professionals.

Is a licence compulsory for renovations?

It depends on the municipality, property use, scope and type of work. Notification, a responsible declaration, a licence and a technical design may be required; structural alterations and changes of use merit particular review. Consult the local council and a competent technical professional before starting. Do not promise a general exemption from licences.

What happens if I find suspected asbestos-containing material?

Do not cut, sand, break or remove it yourself. Stop work that could affect it and consult competent personnel for identification and management under Spanish regulations. The UK HSE offers a useful explanation of pre-work surveys, but its obligations do not replace Spanish ones.

What if the home is very old and may contain lead paint?

Exposure to contaminated dust is a potential risk when old finishes are disturbed. In the United States, the EPA regulates work in certain buildings dating from before 1978; **that threshold is American, not a Spanish rule**. In Spain, the material must be assessed and relevant safety and waste regulations applied.

Can a wall be demolished without structural assessment?

A wall should not be assumed non-load-bearing from its thickness or appearance. Before opening or demolishing it, identify its function, bearings, services and possible requirements for a design, licence and professional supervision.

What should be done if new cracks appear during work?

Stop work in the affected area, mark off and secure the surroundings where appropriate, document developments and request a technical assessment. Do not continue potentially structural demolition without assessment.